

EMAIL TEXT EXTRACT

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Date: Fri, 9 Nov 2018 16:41:33 +1100

From: help@mhcc.vic.gov.au

To: rich@richmclean.com.au

Subject: Private and Confidential Mental Health Complaints Commissioner -Your complaint

Dear Mr McLean

Your complaint

Thank you for your correspondence received by the Mental Health Complaints Commissioner (MHCC) on 9 November 2018, outlining your concerns with several mental health practitioners.

We are sorry to hear about your experiences with these practitioners and we acknowledge the detail you have provided in your email to us.

The MHCC is established under the Mental Health Act 2014 to receive and resolve complaints about publically funded mental health services in Victoria, such as hospitals or community mental health teams.

The MHCC does not have jurisdiction to deal with issues relating to private practitioners.

If your complaint relates to private practitioners, the Health Complaints Commissioner (HCC) maybe the appropriate body to consider your concerns. More information about the HCC is available on their website at: <https://hcc.vic.gov.au/>.

Alternatively, the Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency (AHPRA) maybe the appropriate body to consider your concerns. More information about AHPRA is available on their website at: <https://www.ahpra.gov.au/>.

Thank you for bringing your concerns to the attention of the MHCC. If you would like further information or our assistance in referring your concerns to HCC, please do not hesitate to contact our office on 1800 246 054 or by email at help@mhcc.vic.gov.au.

Yours sincerely

Ilaria Mirabella
Resolutions Administration and Support Officer

Mental Health Complaints Commissioner
T: 1800 246 054 | F: (03) 9949 1506
Level 26, 570 Bourke Street, Melbourne, VIC 3000
mhcc.vic.gov.au

The Mental Health Complaints Commissioner respectfully acknowledges the Traditional Owners of the country throughout Victoria and pays respect to their Elders, both past and present.

Please consider the environment before printing this email.

CONFIDENTIALITY AND PRIVACY

The information in this message and in any attachments may be

confidential. If you are not the intended recipient of this message, you must not read, forward, print, copy, disclose, or use in any way the information contained in this message or any attachment(s) it contains. The Mental Health Complaints Commissioner is committed to protecting the privacy and confidentiality of any personal information provided to us. If you are not the intended recipient, please notify the sender immediately, or notify us by email on PrivacyFOI@mhcc.vic.gov.au, and delete or destroy all copies of this message and any attachments.

From:
Rich McLean <rich@richmclean.com.au>
To:
help@mhcc.vic.gov.au,
Date:
09/11/2018 03:19 PM
Subject:
From Rich Mclean

Dear MHCC,

I have stopped just short of sending out this email and potentially ruining professions.

I don't want to be antagonistic but I want my needs met, and they have not been.

Can you please read over this letter and advise what I might do next?

Sincerely,

Rich Mclean

Richard McLean,
? Doctor of Philosophy Research Student,
? College of Education,
? Victoria University, Melbourne.
? PH : (+61) 0418391532
? Email: rich@richmclean.com.au

Artist, Illustrator, Author, PhD Researcher.

? Personal Website: <https://www.richmclean.com.au/>
? New Art Book:
<https://www.richmclean.com.au/a-certain-beauty-in-un-resolution>
? Drawing Portfolio: <https://www.richmclean.com.au/drawing>
? LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/richardwmclean/>
? Twitter: <https://twitter.com/RichMcLean>
? Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/richmcleanartist>

I acknowledge the Elders, families and ancestors of the Boonwurrung and Wurundjeri of the Kulin who are the traditional owners of the land on which I live in Footscray. I acknowledge that this land is the place of age old ceremonies of celebration, initiation and renewal and that the Kulin Nation people's living culture has a unique role in the life of our

region.

Dear Dr Horgan, Dr Ibrahim, Dr Qwong, Dr Parker, the lovely Dr McCurdy, my NDIS provider, Office of The Chief Psychiatrist, Slater and Gordon Lawyers, Maurice & Blackburn Lawyers, Dr SD from Ocean Grove, reception at Millenium Medical Centre and lastly Dr Whittaker,

You all know me as Rich McLean, that nice artist guy with complex psychiatric needs who is doing the PhD. Nice bloke, shame if he was dead because his health care workers could not come together to ethically treat him with the medication that has proved to have worked and saved his life.

I am writing to you all today with a) a demand for the medication I so desperately need and

b) yet another cry for help which I hope for all your sakes you will comply immediately.

You must all know upfront I have secret recordings of conversations with you all.

I have attached two snippets below from Dr Ibraim (2017) and Dr Whittaker (2018), so you all know this to be true. I know it is unethical, but I must say that I have only done so out of desperation to receive the medicine and the ethical help I so desperately need. I know how the system works, I have fought it before, and I must warn you I have a fierce resilience not just to live and stay alive, but for justice.

No further action will be taken if I get the all my scripts and a referral to an overseeing psychiatrist here in ocean grove. I do not like to think of the other side of the coin for all your sakes.

Introduction

As you all know, I am a highly intelligent autobiographer artist illustrator academic and former public advocate with mental health and mental health recovery, and human rights awarded author. To date, I have been diagnosed with schizophrenia, which I disagree with, PTSD, likely Bipolar, (I?m more inclined to agree with that), chronic depression, mood disorder and panic attacks.

I know what is best for me, and to the best of my knowledge, there has been a failure to adequately take care of my needs as a consumer of mental health services concerning the medication I need (Listed below). If there were no failure, I would have my script, and I would not have to be threatening with this email!

The facts

Dr Horgan referred me to Dr Qwong. Dr Qwong refuses to offer me a license for my script even though she wrote a letter to Dr Whittaker in 2017 advocating saying I take 3 x dexamphetamine a day rather than two which he agreed to and was granted.

Dr Parker refused to see me and recommended I see my GP or Dr Kwong. I did see my GP Dr Whittaker, and he could not support a psychiatrist, in fact, he just gave me a printed sheet of psychiatrists.

Dr Ibrahim was hopeless and did not respond adequately to my suicidal ideation, which has now thankfully passed although I still have enough medication.

Dr Kwong referred me to Dr Whittaker. Then I moved, and I have seen 5 x GP's one of which said it was no problem, but he had reached his limit of seven prescriptions for dexamphetamine and therefore could not legally help me. That Dr was Dr SD from Ocean Grove, a lovely man who will be seen favourably in a court of law.

I have had to take these desperate measures to protect my health and receive the care I deserve as a human being who is deserving of attention care and happiness.

Today I shared Dr Daniel McCurdy's frustration with DHS for such a simple thing. He was kind and generous and will be seen in a wonderfully human light.

I have recorded (in audio format on my phone), sessions and phone calls with Dr Ibrahim, Dr Whittaker, reception of millennium medical clinic, Leanda Vatima, the practise manager from Millenium Medical Centre, and Dr Qwong without you all knowing. Dr Horgan also has an ethical responsibility to ethically keep the recordings of our session for seven years to my knowledge. His original letter (attached), clearly states the benefits of me using dexamphetamine to my well being.

The case is clear: I need the medication, and none of you are co-operating. I am sorry it has come to this.

In most of those sessions, I have expressed my frustrations with inadequate help and frustrations with being suicidal and still not getting the help I deserve. Every response to my complex needs that were not met is documented.

I have recordings of not even five-minute sessions with Dr Kwong where she referred to me as 'her friend' and not 'her client' because I did not have a valid referral. I have recordings stating suicidal ideation for Dr Ibrahim and Dr Whittaker and Dr Kwong. None of these was followed up. There are records of me attending Footscray Hospital in the last few months of a suspected heart attack, and because there was a long wait-I left. It is documented. I did not care if I had died. These are facts that would be very clear to demonstrate in a court.

In my life, I have helped thousands of people through my autobiography and advocacy work. All I need is someone to help me.

I now need at least one of you to help me access the medication I need, or all of my recordings and also this email will be published, and I will seek legal advice. (Even without the event of my as yet at this stage unlikely death).

Dr Ibrahim:

I told you I was suicidal and you told me to come back in four months.
Unethical cash grab. Cost: \$400

Dr Horgan:

You know dexamphetamine is a life-saving medication for me, even though you only saw me once and charged \$735. You refuse to see me again after you made your money. Unethical. Uncaring. You refer me off to Dr Kwong who says she has no experience with prescribing dexamphetamine, even though she had. Cash grab.

Dr Qwong:

I told you I was suicidal and you told me I a) need a referral and b) need Dr Whittaker to provide you with evidence or a licence for dexamphetamine. You display a high level of rudeness and are not professional, and one of the meetings lasted about three minutes which was a total waste of time. This will be seen as preposterous. You offered me medications and scripts without a referral. This is illegal. This may well come out in court.

To Millenium medical Clinic:

I called in September and recorded the conversation with the receptionist asking Dr Whittaker to a) provide a referral to Dr Stella Kwong and b) provide the evidence of dexamphetamine so I can get the help I need. (Simply upping the dose to 4 x 5mg tabs a day).

You said it was ?higher? than Dr Whittaker, and directed me back to Dr Horgan, who then directs me to Dr Qwong, who then directs me to Dr Whittaker.

To all of you:

I don?t believe I am getting the health care I need, and you have all forced me to act in this way. For the record, I do not agree with the ?diagnosis? of schizophrenia.

This is my medication, which I monitor myself:

60 mg zeldox morning and night,
4 x 5mg Dexamphetamine in the morning to help me study and so I am awake,
not depressed and berate myself for sleeping, (On another note you will be all be so pleased to know that I have passed my ?towards submission? candidature for my PhD with flying colours),
200mg Solian at night,
10mg Valium at night,
20mg Paroxetine in the morning.

I am extremely well - there is no need for intervention - I just need help.

Dr Whittaker:

I told you I was suicidal, and also that I was saving up credit cards to live like a king overseas for a year than top myself. You said I may fall through the cracks. The whole conversation is recorded. This is behaviour that is unresponsive to evidence of a crisis. It is unethical. Any professional opinion if it were to be bought before the courts would be to call the cat team or at least talk about my intentions. I'm a nice person. I don't want to ruin the good parts of our relationship.

Dr Qwong:

You make me come in for appointments which last about three minutes to tell me things you could have said to me on the phone. You are wasting both our time and not helping matters. You say you are not a specialist yet you advocated for my dose to be put up to 3 x tablets a day?so which one is it? It is clear about your unethical practices. This will be seen as preposterous.

Dr Parker:

It?s hard to believe a person of your standing with the Blackdog institute who has seen me personally as a client cannot recommend a bulk billing

psychiatrist in Melbourne. Very disappointing that you threw me off like that. I consider that you ostracised, excluded and neglected me. Where is the care?

Dr Horgan:

You refuse to see me yet you know the medication is life-saving. I find this highly unethical and wish for you to intervene ASAP.

Dr Ibrahim:

You are useless. How dare you tell me to come back in four months when I told you I was suicidal.

You have all failed in your duties to be ethical and responsible, even though I am not ungrateful for the 'other' 'care' you have each provided. I am not a monster.

I am a keen observer of the medical profession and human rights awarded advocate. I believe that you have all shown unethical disregard regarding your care for me.

To be complicit when neglect and abuse happens is to 'put up with it' and condone it and I do not intend to do either.

To Dr McCurdy,

Thank you for trying to help me today. You have shown great care, and I could see you had a human face about you.

The evidence and the outcome:

I request of you all (I don't care who) that I receive my script of 3-4 dexamphetamine a day plus other medication. I don't care who. You had all better start communicating with one another.

I am not getting the help I need. I am rightly taking my power back.

I have been forced to do this. The medication has been life-saving for me.

I have decided NOT to attach a recent diary entry which I will share possibly in court about reasons why I should kill myself to show the seriousness of this matter, and which I spoke to Dr Whittaker about.

I must state that I am well, and coping after relocating to Ocean grove despite family issues, my dog dying, being broke, the stress of a PhD and the frustration with the mental health system.

If you could all please all come together to comply with my wishes that would be great.

To show that I have you all recorded, I have attached two snippets of my 'data collection' from Dr Ibrahim on the 22nd Dec 2017 and Dr Whittaker right up until 07 Aug 2018. You are all on file and recorded.

I don't wish to be unkind but this is a matter possibly of life and death, and the outcome is pure and reflects the proper ethical treatment of another human being.

I need you all to work with me otherwise I will consider making all this public and / or look into legal options.

I have attached two snippets of recording from way back to Dr Ibrahim and Dr Whittaker so you can all gravitate to the seriousness of this matter and the reasons why you should all fall into line and please help me help myself. I am an expert and THE expert in my care.

I am crying out for help.

If you all do not comply, you will bear the cost of my intellect and my insight, and also my voracity for justice to shine through with such extreme persistence I possess that none of you could ever possibly be prepared for.

Sincerely,

Richard Mclean

FROM DR HORGAN:

Hello

Sorry I cannot intervene. Dr Kwong can give a further opinion re your dose

Regards

David Horgan

On 7 Aug 2018, at 9:10 am, Rich McLean <rich@richmclean.com.au> wrote:
Dear Dr Horgan,

You will remember I came to you about just over a year ago for a dexamphetamine script, for my drug resistant depression and suicidality.

I am writing to you today because a couple of months after that I got Dr Stella Kwong to recommend three instead of two dexamphetamine to my GP because that was what I was using.

I now ask that you write to my GP Dr John Whittaker and recommend that it be upped to four a day, because this is what I have felt to be most beneficial, for my well being, keeping above the suicidality and also for concentration with my demanding PhD work.

Could you please confirm you will comply with recommending to Dr Whittaker that the licence to prescribe dexamphetamine will now reflect four 5mg a day rather than three?

Thanks for your assistance, this could really save a life.

Sincerely,

Rich Mclean

FROM DR GORDON PARKER:

I certainly remember you Rich and sorry to hear how things are going. Regrettably, I don't know of any bulk billers in Melbourne but your GP should know or you could ring the RANZCP College ? which is in Melbourne. I hope it works out. Cheers, Gordon

Professor Gordon Parker AO

Scientia Professor
School of Psychiatry

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From: Rich McLean [mailto:rich@richmclean.com.au]
Sent: Monday, 6 August 2018 3:20 PM
To: Gordon Parker
Subject: From Rich McLean

Dear Dr Parker,

This email is a cry for help from someone from your distant past.

My name is Rich McLean, I'm not sure if you remember me.

I did a keynote speech for an exhibition in Sydney many years ago, 'Art Against Stigma'.

After the talk, you came up to me and introduced yourself as a professional who believed I had bipolar instead of schizophrenia.

Life for me has been a roller coaster for years?

I may be mad but I'm not silly and I'm doing a PhD at Victoria University here in melb.

I have helped so many people over the years, both with my autobiography on recovery from my psychosis and all the public speaking and lecturing I have done, and now I am hoping you will help me.

I wanted to touch base to ask if you knew of a bulk billing psychiatrist in melbourne you could suggest on making an appointment with?

Alas I have not much money and live just about under the poverty line, and I am aware that mental health support drops off after about age 25. I'm now 45 and I am overseeing my own medication which of course is troublesome.

I have devastating lows and have been prescribed dexamphetamine which has been a life saver. However my thou
[extract truncated]